had been residing in the lands of his ancestor, Chaghatai Khān, the second son of Genghis Khān. Each time Mīrzā brought Khān to Ferghana, lands were gifted to him. In the meantime, Yunus Khān kept on shifting between Ferghana and Moghūlistan. The last time Mīrzā invited Yunus Khān, he had taken possession of Tashkent. Babur mentions in the *Baburnama* that local texts referred to Tashkent as Shash and Chach. He gave Tashkent to Khān in AD 1485 and till AD 1503, it along with Shahrukhiya country was owned by the Chaghatai Khāns.

Till AD 1494, the Moghūl Khānship existed in the hands of Yunus Khān's younger son and half-brother of Babur's mother, Sulṭān Mahmud Khān. Umar Shaikh Mīrzā's offending behaviour had been upsetting Mahmud Khān and his elder brother Sulṭān Ahmad Mīrzā, the ruler of Samarkand. Ahmad Mīrzā and Sulṭān Mahmud Khān forged an agreement. The former married his daughter to the latter. Soon they led their army against Umar Shaikh Mīrzā. The first pack of the soldiers advanced along the south of the Khujand-water and the second along its north.

But the universe had planned something different which neither Ahmad nor Mahmud would have thought of.

The fort of Akhsi was situated above a deep and steep gorge, and misfortune was knocking at the doors of Babur.

On 8 June of AD 1494, Umar Shaikh Mīrzā met with an accident in the palace that stood by the steep edge of the gorge while feeding the birds he adored a lot.

Babur writes, 'Umar Shaikh Mīrzā flew, with his pigeons and their house, and became a falcon.'*

The twelve-year-old prince had lost his father who was just thirty-eight years old then.

Umar was born in Samarkand in AD 1456 to Tīmūrid emperor Sulṭān Abu-Sa'id Mīrzā. He was the fourth son after Sulṭān Ahmad Mīrzā, Sulṭān Muhammad Mīrzā and Sulṭān Mahmud Mīrzā. His father, Sulṭān Abu-Sa'id Mīrzā, was born to Sulṭān Muhammad Mīrzā. Muhammad Mīrzā was born to Timur Beg's third son, Miran-Shah Beg. Umar Shaikh Mīrzā I and Jahangir Mīrzā were his elder brothers and Shahrukh Mīrzā was the younger.

Abu-Sa'id Mīrzā had given him Kābul and was allowed to proceed under the guardianship of Baba-I-Kābuli. In AD 1456, he was called back to Samarkand from Tamarisk Valley for the circumcision ritual, followed by a grand feast.